

ZHEJIAN WANG

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Postdoctoral Fellow, National School of Development, Peking University

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENT

Peking University
Postdoctoral Fellow, National School of Development

September 2026–Present
Beijing, China

FIELDS & RESEARCH INTERESTS

Fields: Applied Microeconomics; Development Economics; Labor Economics.

Research areas: Economics of education; family economics; digital economics.

Interests: Human capital formation; family institutions; digital regulation and platform markets.

EDUCATION

University of Delaware
Ph.D. in Economics, Alfred Lerner College of Business and Economics

2020–2026
Newark, DE, USA

- Degree conferred August 18, 2026.
- **Dissertation:** Essays in Digital Economics. **Advisor:** Jeremy Tobacman.
- **Selected coursework:** Econometric Theory I–II; Time-Series Econometrics; Topics in Dynamic Modeling; Cross-Section and Panel Data; Development Economics; Household Finance (Theory & Empirics); Labor Economics.

University of Southern California
M.A. in Economics

2016
Los Angeles, CA, USA

Southwestern University of Finance and Economics
B.S. in Management; major in E-Commerce

2014
China

RESEARCH

Publications

Restricting video games in China: Effects on time use, educational achievement, and health

Sole-authored. *Journal of Development Economics* **182** (2026), 103812. doi:10.1016/j.jdeveco.2026.103812.

Abstract: Screen time regulation for minors is among the most widely adopted digital policies globally, yet credible causal evidence on its effects remains scarce. I study China's 2021 regulation, which virtually eliminated weekday online gaming for minors and limited play to one hour on weekends/holidays—the strictest intervention of its kind. Using nationally representative CFPS data (2020, 2022) in a difference-in-differences design, I find sharp declines in minors' gaming and total Internet use but no robust improvements in study effort, academic performance, or physical health, with suggestive declines in mental well-being. A complementary Regression Kink design using city mock-exam data around the age-18 cutoff likewise shows no exam effects. The null results on human capital despite effective compliance challenge the assumptions underpinning screen time regulation worldwide and inform ongoing policy debates in the US, EU, and elsewhere.

Premarital property rights and marriage entry: evidence from urban China

Zhejian Wang and Ruoming Zhang. *Review of Economics of the Household* (2026). doi:10.1007/s11150-026-09890-w.

Working Paper

Digital Regulation and Market Responses: Evidence from Chinese Mobile Apps

Sole-authored.

Work in Progress

Higher-Education Expansion and Upper-Secondary Choice

With Yiqun Tong and Ruoming Zhang.

From Seats to Status: China's 1999 Higher-Education Expansion and Urban–Rural Occupational Mobility

With Yiqun Tong and Ruoming Zhang.

Work in Progress (continued)

When Success Becomes Salient: Local Role Models and Schooling Decisions

With Ruoming Zhang.

Less Paperwork, More Marriages: Registration Frictions and Marriage Outcomes

With Ruoming Zhang.

Generative AI as a Product Feature in iOS Apps

Legal Clarification and Judicial Consistency: Evidence from China

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Delaware

Teaching

Fall 2022–Spring 2023

Newark, DE, USA

- Introduction to Microeconomics (ECON 101), Fall 2022.
- Introduction to Macroeconomics (ECON 103), Spring 2023.

University of Delaware

Teaching Assistant

Fall 2021–Spring 2025

Newark, DE, USA

- **Graduate:** Microeconomic Theory I–II (ECON 811, 813).
- **Undergraduate:** Data Analysis for Economics (ECON 306); Quantitative Micro Theory (ECON 301); Urban Economics (ECON 393); Health Policy; Management Information Systems (MISY 261).

FELLOWSHIPS & RESEARCH FUNDING

Graduate Fellowship, University of Delaware

2020–2025

Third-Year Summer Research Stipend, University of Delaware

Summer 2023

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Prof. David Stockman, University of Delaware

Spring 2024

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Caitong Securities Co., Ltd.

Internet Industry Research Division

2017–2020

Shanghai, China

Assistant Analyst (2017–2018); Analyst (2019–2020).

- Covered digital platform firms and technology regulation as a sell-side equity analyst; this experience motivated my academic research on digital economics and market responses to regulation.

SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Software: Stata, R, Python, L^AT_EX, SQL.

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native); English (fluent).

Professional examinations: Passed all three levels of the CFA Program.

PRESENTATIONS

University of Delaware Economics Seminar Series (December 2025); University of Delaware ESGA Conference (October 2025).

REFERENCES

Jeremy Tobacman

University of Delaware
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George R. Parsons

University of Delaware
gparsons@udel.edu

Emily L. Battaglia

University of Delaware
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Desmond J. Toohey

Securities and Exchange Commission
(formerly University of Delaware)
desmondtoohey@gmail.com